

Excursion risk management plan for regular community walks to Gloucester Community Gardens & Billabong Park



This Risk Management Plan is to be used with the Regular Community Walks Document

Excursion details			
Date(s) of excursion	May 2023 to May 2024	Excursion destination	Gloucester Community Garden
Departure and arrival times	Between 9am – 11am		
Proposed activities	Gloucester Community Garden for Exploration of gardening skills and plants. Gloucester Billabong Park, to use large outdoor play equipment.	Water hazards? Yes If yes, detail in risk assessment below.	
Method of transport, including proposed route	All of the excursions will involve walking so only children wearing enclosed shoes and broadbrim hats may attend the excursions. Thongs and crocs will not be accepted as safe footwear. Walking excursions may involve children walking along footpaths or grassed sidewalks, crossing local streets and playing in unfenced parks.		
Name of excursion co-ordinator	The Nominator Supervisor will review the destination and risks against the excursion risk management plan before each excursion.		
Contact number of excursion co-ordinator	(BH) 0490520050	(M)	
Number of children attending excursion	2 to 20	Number of educators/parents/volunteers	1:10 ratio with a min. of 2 educators or 1 educator and one parent.
Educator to child ratio, including whether this excursion warrants a higher ratio? Please provide details.	Each walking excursion and the number of children taken will be assessed individually. As a guide: - Two educators can take a minimum of 2 children and a maximum of 20 children. - Three or more educators can take a minimum of 3 children and a maximum of 1:10 adult to child ratio for groups of children.		

Who can attend the excursions?	Children: • age 3 years of age or older • who parents/ guardians have signed regular outing permission form • who are wearing safe footwear • who are wearing sun safe clothing & hat
Excursion checklist	
☐ First aid kit	☐ List of adults participating in the excursion
☐ List of children attending the excursion	☐ Contact information for each adult
☐ Contact information for each child	☐ Mobile phone / other means of communicating with the service & emergency services
☐ Medical information for each child	☐ Other items, please list

Risk assessment							
Activity	Hazard identified	Likelihood	Consequence	Risk assessment	Elimination/control measures	Who	When
Contact with members of the Community Garden Club	• Strangers: ○ Taking a child ○ indecent exposure/language	Rare	Major	Moderate	• Good supervision of children. • Regularly checking total number of children • Education of stranger danger	Educators	Before excursion During excursions
	Community members causing physical or mental abuse of a child/ren eg. In appropriate touching of a child	Rare	Major	Moderate	• Community member will not be left alone with a child/ren • Educators will remain directly supervising at all times	Educators	During excursions

	Community members taking photos of the children on their personal devices and used for unsolicited purposes eg pornography				- The experience will occur in open places with high visibility of the children and adults at all times - Community members will not be permitted to take photos of the children		
Activities children participate in at the community garden	Toxic or dangerous plants/soils	Possible	Major	High	- Equipment safety - Good supervision of children. - Educator to discuss with garden members about plants growing on site checked for suitability on the toxic plants register prior to presenting to the children. - Children and educators will wash their hands after touching the soil and plants.	Educators to liaise with the Garden club prior to visit to get a list of plant species. Transitioning from the planting session to gathering for walk back to preschool will be supervised.	Before and during excursions
	Children eating/consuming dangerous plants	Possible	Major	High	Discussion with children on not putting plants in their mouths	Educators	Before excursions During excursion

					Children supervised throughout their time at the gardens	Educators	During excursion
	Children/Educators ingesting soil/plant based pollutants	Possible	Major	High	- Wash hands - Planting will occur in highly ventilated area - Children and adults to wash their hands after coming into contact with soil - First Aid kit nearby - Educators have current first aid training	Educators	During excursion
	Children/Educators getting cuts/graze injuries from garden tools	Possible	Minor	Low	- Garden tools checked for suitability prior to use - Children supervised and instructed on safe use of tools - Children supervised using gardening tools to prevent injuries - No excessively sharp tools will be used - Enclosed shoes will be used while using potentially dangerous gardening tools	Educators will assist the Garden Club members to observe the children using tools safely Direct supervision while using tools	During use
	Children stabbing themselves or others with sharp garden forks, spades losing finger or toe	Rare	Moderate	Low			
Water Hazards-	There is a creek located on the western side of town (see map below). The water level of this creek rises & falls due to rainfall in	Rare	Catastrophic	High	Excursions are cancelled when: - there is a risk of flooding. - Access alerts from BOM, ABC radio, Gloucester Community radio, local SES	Educators	Before excursion During excursions

	the local & surrounding district. ○ Risk is drowning				• High chance of rain forecasted during the day. • When ground is sudden from continual rain over the previous days. Good supervision of children. Regularly checking total number of children		
Playground Equipment in Billabong Park	○ Flying Fox ○ Suspended bridge ○ Swings ○ Climbing equipment ○ Slide ○ Pyramid climbing structure.	Unlikely	Major	High	• Discussion with children on how to use the equipment safely. • Good supervision of children. • Educator will not lift children onto equipment if child is too short or doesn't have the skills to climb. • If necessary, set height climbing limits and the number of children on each piece of equipment at one time.	Educators	Before excursion During excursions

Plan prepared by	Elizabeth Price	
Prepared in consultation with:	Educators and Management Committee	
Communicated to:	Parents, Management Committee and staff	
Venue and safety information reviewed and attached	Yes. Comment if needed: Map of area covered by regular excursions	
Reminder: Monitor the effectiveness of controls and change if necessary. Review the risk assessment if an incident or significant change occurs.		

Review

The Management, employees, families and interested parties will monitor and review the effectiveness of this policy annually or more regularly if required.

- Reviewed by: Elizabeth Price
Supervisor

Date: 25/05/2023

- Accepted by Committee Member:

Position: *Treasurer*

Name: *Clare MacGregor*

Signature: *Clare MacGregor*

Date: *31/5/23*

- Previously reviewed: 17/06/2022

Date for next review: 24/05/2024

Risk assessment Matrix		What would be the consequence of this emergency				
What is the likelihood that this emergency will occur?	Almost certain	Insignificant	Minor	Moderate	Major	Catastrophic
	Likely	Moderate	High	High	Extreme	Extreme
	Possible	Moderate	Moderate	High	Extreme	Extreme
	Unlikely	Low	Moderate	High	High	Extreme
	Rare	Low	Low	Moderate	High	High

Signature: *Elizabeth Price*

Position: Nominated



